chemical, and biological weapons and their means of delivery, would be central to both our intelligence gathering and our prevention efforts. I predicted the possibility of a renewed “eastern front,” which, if realized, would become a major threat to the State of Israel. I anticipated that terrorist activity would become a central priority for us. I recognized that western Europe, our main arena of activity, would become more difficult and complicated to operate in because of our political situation and our eroding popularity in the court of public opinion, which would adversely affect western Europe’s willingness to “tolerate” our independent activity on their territory. I foresaw the reduced cooperation with European intelligence agencies with regard to the terrorist organizations operating under the umbrella of the PLO. Even back then I saw that the computer would become a main target of attack on our part and that innovative technologies with composite materials would play an important role in the development of our future tools.

I argued that these changes, which would become the future challenges of the Mossad, would require us to make structural changes, divert efforts, and break new ground toward new goals, using innovative and sophisticated means. This would be quite a jolt to the organization, but it would be carried out gradually and would develop out of the sense of continuity that characterized the Mossad.

All of my predictions were correct, but I could not have foreseen the extent of their force and scope. In January 1994, I delivered a lecture at the National Defense College on the role of the Mossad in light of the changes taking place in the international and regional order. If in the past I had presented my predictions for the future, in this lecture I summed up the past. Specifically, what took place between 1989 and early 1994?

- The Soviet Union collapsed, and the Cold War that had begun in 1945 ended with a crushing victory for the United States and Western democracies.
- The bipolar world became unipolar and was on its way to becoming multipolar.
- This new world’s multipolarity was not only military; it was also reflected in economic blocs: